

AudioRemove-AC3.ps1 v3.7

No video re-encoding; pure remux via FFmpeg. Audio bytes are copied identically.

Purpose:

Remove all **low-bitrate** legacy AC3 and E-AC3 audio tracks.

Result:

"Lean Master" movie contains only video and **high-fidelity audio**, which is retained (TrueHD/AAC 7.1/DTS-HD MA).

Use:

Prepares **mkv** movie for Conversion Engines (DDP51 / Keep71) to generate high-quality, high-bitrate (1024k) E-AC3 5.1 compatibility tracks.

Requirements

PowerShell 7.6 - [Click here to Download PS 7.6 \(Windows x64 .msi\)](#)

FFmpeg 8.1 - <https://ffmpeg.org/download.html>

(Windows 11)

1. Place **AudioRemove-AC3.ps1** , **ffmpeg.exe** , and **ffprobe.exe** in the same folder.
2. Run the script:

```
pwsh -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\AudioRemove-AC3.ps1 ".\YourMovie.mkv"
```

The -ExecutionPolicy Bypass only applies to this single run and doesn't change your system settings.

macOS / Linux

1. Place the script, **ffmpeg** , and **ffprobe** in the same folder.
2. Make the binaries executable (first time only):

```
chmod +x ffmpeg ffprobe
```

3. Run:

```
pwsh -File ./AudioRemove-AC3.ps1 "./YourMovie.mkv"
```

- The script will create a new file: YourMovie_**remux**.mkv
- If the file exists, it will auto-increment safely.

1. Subtitle streams

You can switch subtitle handling at runtime by passing **-KeepAllSubs** on the command line:
Runtime switching is temporary.

```
pwsh -File .\AudioRemove-AC3.ps1 ".\Movie.mkv" -KeepAllSubs
```

To keep or drop subtitles, change **line 34** in the script. Remember to save file afterwards.

```
[switch]$KeepAllSubs = $false <<< change to $True  
  
$false: (default) Drops non-English, keeps English + untagged only.  
$true : Keeps all subtitles including non-English.
```

- Subtitles kept or dropped are reported in the summary table.

You can also hide subtitle details from the console output using **-SubtitleInfo Disable**:

```
pwsh -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\AudioRemove-AC3.ps1 ".\Movie.mkv" -SubtitleInfo  
Disable
```

Enable (default): Subtitle rows appear in the summary table and console output.

Disable Subtitle rows are suppressed from console output. The remux result is unchanged.

2. Supported Codecs

Audio Codecs — Kept

Codec Family	Examples
TrueHD	TrueHD 5.1, TrueHD 7.1, TrueHD+Atmos

DTS	DTS Core, DTS-HD MA, DTS-HD HRA
FLAC	All FLAC channel layouts
AAC	AAC LC, HE-AAC, AAC 5.1, AAC 7.1
Opus	Stereo + multichannel
PCM	pcm_s16le, pcm_s24le, pcm_f32le

Audio Codecs — Removed

Codec Family	Codec name	Description
AC3	ac3	Dolby Digital
E-AC3	eac3	Dolby Digital Plus

Attachments — Kept

- Fonts, Cover art stored as an attachment stream, Any MKV attachment stream

Note: Cover art stored as an ATTACHED_PIC video stream is not included when using `-`

`map 0:V?`

To keep use: `0:v?`

To remove use: `0:V?`

3. Global FFmpeg Options

Ensure stable remuxing, correct metadata handling, and safe processing of large files.

- `-n` : Never overwrite an existing output file.
Why: Keeps the auto-increment logic safe. FFmpeg exits immediately if the output path already exists.
- `-loglevel error` : Suppresses all FFmpeg output except actual errors.
- `-loglevel warning` : Shows warnings and errors, but hides info, debug, and trace output.
- `-nostats` & `-progress pipe:1`
What:** Disables FFmpeg's default stats line and enables machine-readable progress

output.

Why:** Allows the script to read `out_time` values and drive a live percentage progress bar. `-stats_period 0.2` sets the update rate every 0.2 seconds for a smoother bar.

- **`-probesize 200M` & `-analyzeduration 200M`**

What: Deep probe of the input container.

Why: Ensures accurate detection of audio/subtitle streams, especially in large MKVs.

- **`-fflags +discardcorrupt`**

What:** Discards corrupt packets instead of aborting.

Why: Prevents remux failures on slightly damaged files.

- **`-avoid_negative_ts make_zero`**

What: Normalizes timestamps to start at zero.

Why: Prevents sync drift caused by negative PTS values.

- **`-map_metadata 0` & `-map_chapters 0`**

What: Copies global metadata and chapter markers.

Why: Preserves the original file's structure.

- **`-map 0:V?`**

What: Maps all video streams except attached pictures (ATTACHED_PIC flag).

Why: Ensures video is preserved without modification.

- **`-c copy`**

What: Stream-copy mode for all mapped streams.

Why: Guarantees zero quality loss and maximum speed.

- **`-max_muxing_queue_size 14000`**

What: Increases the internal muxer packet buffer.

Why: Prevents the video stream from flooding the mux queue on long files. Applied after the map args, just before `-c copy`.

Playback Assignment Rules

To ensure smooth playback, the rules are as follows:

- The first kept audio track will be set as **default**
- All other audio tracks will be set to **none**

4. Summary Report

After processing, the script generates a detailed table:

Column	Description
Idx	Original stream index. Dropped subtitle rows use <code>-</code> as a placeholder.
Codec	Codec name for audio, subtitle, or attachment stream.
Action	Kept , Removed , or Dropped .
Rule	Reason for the action taken.

Every video stream always appears as a **Video passthrough** row — it is never modified.

Audio track titles: The script stamps the original track title onto each kept audio track using `-metadata:s:a:N`.
This ensures VLC and other players display the correct track name regardless of how the source stored it.

Subtitle rows: Subtitle rows only appear in the table when `-SubtitleInfo` is set to `Enable` (the default).
Pass `-SubtitleInfo Disable` to suppress them from the console output. The remux result is unchanged either way.

Color Coding for above table

- **White** > Video passthrough
- **Green** > Kept audio
- **Red** > Removed AC3/E-AC3
- **Cyan** > Kept subtitles (English or untagged)
- **Yellow** > Non-English subtitles dropped
- **Magenta** > Kept attachments

5. Non-Critical FFmpeg Warnings (**Safe to Ignore**)

These warnings may appear during remuxing but **do not affect output quality**.

“discarding packet”

- Caused by minor corruption in the source
- Safe due to `+discardcorrupt`

“non-monotonous DTS”

- Happens when timestamps overlap
- Remux corrects this automatically

“Subtitle: unspecified size”

- Common for PGS subtitles
- Subtitles are copied untouched

“Estimating duration from bitrate, this may be inaccurate”

- FFmpeg recalculates duration during muxing
- Safe to Ignore